DJBILBOX BEATS / HUMPIRE

ARENA BASS

Stadium-size bass synthesizer: 808 subs, slap, reese, acid, horns and kicks from eight synthesis engines.

Version 1.0 - Windows (VST3) and macOS (VST3 / Audio Unit) - Royalty-free license

Contents

ARENA BASS
- Overview
- Quick start in FL Studio
- Interface
- Parameters
- Factory presets
- Production tips
- MIDI, automation and performance
- FAQ

ARENA BASS

Stadium-size bass synthesizer: 808 subs, slap, reese, acid, horns and kicks from eight synthesis engines.

Type	Synthesizer (VST3 instrument)
Format	VST3 64-bit (Windows)
Developer	DJBILBOX BEATS
Version	1.0
Factory presets	70
Latency	0 samples

Overview

ARENA BASS is a bass synthesizer by Humpire / DJBILBOX BEATS. It uses no samples. Every sound is generated in real time by one of eight engines: a sine sub with a pitch “knock”, a plucked-string slap bass, a Moog Bass engine (two saws, a square and a sub octave), a detuned Stadium Reese, a two-operator FM Growl, an Acid Rubber voice with a self-closing resonant filter, a Stadium Horns brass section and an Arena Kick for pitched kicks and stomps.

Five character controls (TONE, BODY, BRIGHT, WIDTH, TEXTURE) reshape each engine. The sound then goes through a multimode filter with its own envelope, an amplitude envelope, an LFO and a master effects chain: distortion, chorus, ping-pong delay and reverb. The character is big, punchy and direct, made for sport-arena energy and hard-hitting low end.

ARENA BASS targets Trap, Drill and Hip-Hop 808s, Afrotrap and Afro bass lines, G-Funk slides, Deep House and acid bass, plus horn stabs and anthem hooks. Bass presets load in Mono mode for clean, one-note-at-a-time lines. The Stadium Horns bank plays chords in Poly mode with up to 16 voices.

Quick start in FL Studio

1. In the **Channel rack**, click **+** and choose **ARENA_BASS** (vendor **DJBILBOX BEATS**). You can also drag it from the **Plugin database > Generators** browser.
2. The plugin opens on **ARENA BASS - Init Patch**: the Arena Sub engine in Poly mode.
3. Click the **folder icon** at the left of the preset display. Pick a bank, then a preset. You can also step through all 70 presets with the **<** and **>** arrows.
4. Play from your MIDI keyboard or draw notes in the **Piano roll**. Bass lines sit best between MIDI notes 24 and 48 (C2 to C4 in FL Studio). Presets with PITCH at -12 sound one octave lower than the key you play.
5. Shape the sound with the three main controls:
   - **TONE**: the main character of the engine (knock, pluck hardness, sub level, FM ratio...).
   - **FILTER**: the cutoff of the filter. Turn it down for a darker, rounder bass.
   - **GLIDE**: slide time between notes. Leave it at zero for straight notes.
6. Adjust **VOLUME** to set the level, then click the **disk icon** to save your own version.

Interface

The window opens at 1000 × 746 pixels. Drag the bottom-right corner to resize it from 50% to 200%. The proportions stay fixed.

Preset display (top center). From left to right: the folder icon (preset menu), the **<** arrow, the current preset name, the **>** arrow and the disk icon (save). The arrows wrap around from the last preset to the first.

EXPANSION cassette (top left). Clicking the cassette opens an information message about upcoming expansion packs. No expansion content is included with version 1.0.

Logo (top right). The DJBILBOXBEATS name and the DB logo.

Center. The camel artwork, the ARENA BASS title and “By Humpire”. The dotted grille at the left of the artwork is decorative.

Character panel (top right, slatted panel). Two rows of small knobs:

- Row 1: **TONE, BODY, BRIGHT, WIDTH, TEXTURE**. The five character controls of the selected engine.
- Row 2: **RES** (filter resonance), **ENV** (filter envelope depth), **DISTORTION** and **DELAY** (delay level).

LFO section (left). RATE and **AMOUNT** set the LFO speed and depth. **PITCH**, also under this header, is the global transposition (-12 to +12 semitones). It is not an LFO control.

Output and effects (right). VOLUME, **REVERB** and **CHORUS**. The header above this row reads “ADSR”, but these knobs are the output level and two effects. The amplitude envelope is the slider bank described below.

Center row. From left to right:

- **ATTACK, DECAY, SUSTAIN, RELEASE**: the amplitude envelope sliders.
- **GLIDE** and **FILTER** knobs.
- **A, D, S, R**: the filter envelope sliders. **VELOCITY**: velocity sensitivity of the level.
- **TIME** and **FEEDBACK**: delay time and delay repeats.

Menu row. Five drop-down menus, from left to right: **Waveform** (engine), **LFO Source** (LFO shape), **Destination** (LFO target), **Filter Type** and **Mono/Poly**. Each menu shows its current value.

Wheels (bottom left). Pitch Bend springs back to the center when you release it. **Modulation** stays where you leave it.

On-screen keyboard (bottom). Click a key to play it. Velocity follows the click position: click near the bottom of a key for a louder note. The keyboard starts at the lowest MIDI note (labeled C-2, which is C0 in FL Studio) and does not scroll. It covers MIDI notes 0 to 31, so the left half is below the audible range. Use a MIDI controller or the Piano roll for normal playing.

Mouse gestures. Drag a knob up or right to increase it. Drag sliders and wheels vertically. Double-click any knob or slider to return it to its default value. The mouse wheel also adjusts controls. A value bubble appears while you drag.

Parameters

Signal flow: engine, then filter, then amplitude envelope (per voice). The voices are summed, then processed by Distortion, Chorus, Delay and Reverb. A DC blocker and a soft limiter protect the output.

ARENA BASS exposes 35 automatable parameters. The host name is shown in parentheses when it differs from the panel label.

Parameter	Range	Default	Function
Waveform (menu)	Arena Sub, Slap Bass, Moog Bass, Stadium Reese, FM Growl, Acid Rubber, Stadium Horns, Arena Kick	Arena Sub	Selects the synthesis engine.
TONE (Tone)	0 to 1	0.5	Character control 1. Its effect depends on the engine (see the table below).
BODY (Body)	0 to 1	0.5	Character control 2. Engine-dependent.
BRIGHT (Brightness)	0 to 1	0.5	Character control 3. Engine-dependent.
WIDTH (Width)	0 to 1	0.3	Character control 4. Engine-dependent (detune, drive, wobble speed...). It is not a stereo width control.
TEXTURE (Texture)	0 to 1	0.2	Character control 5. Engine-dependent (saturation, noise, feedback...).
FILTER (Filter)	40 to 18,000 Hz	9,000 Hz	Filter cutoff. The cutoff follows the keyboard by 25% around middle C.
RES (Resonance)	0 to 1	0.15	Filter resonance.
Filter Type (menu)	Low Pass, High Pass, Band Pass	Low Pass	Filter mode.
ENV (Filter Env)	0 to 1	0	Filter envelope depth. At 1 the envelope opens the cutoff up to 5 octaves. At 0 the filter envelope has no effect.
A (Filter Attack)	0.002 to 3 s	0.002 s	Filter envelope attack time.
D (Filter Decay)	0.02 to 4 s	0.3 s	Filter envelope decay time.
S (Filter Sustain)	0 to 1	0	Filter envelope sustain level.
R (Filter Release)	0.02 to 4 s	0.3 s	Filter envelope release time.
VELOCITY (Velocity)	0 to 1	0.5	How much note velocity changes the level. 0: all notes at the same level. 1: full velocity response.
ATTACK (Attack)	0.001 to 5 s	0.01 s	Amplitude envelope attack time.
DECAY (Decay)	0.01 to 5 s	0.4 s	Amplitude envelope decay time.
SUSTAIN (Sustain)	0 to 1	0.7	Amplitude envelope sustain level.

Parameter	Range	Default	Function
RELEASE (Release)	0.02 to 8 s	0.4 s	Amplitude envelope release time.
VOLUME (Volume)	0 to 1	0.7	Level of each voice, before the effects.
GLIDE (Glide)	0 to 2	0	Portamento. The value is roughly the slide time in seconds. Each new note slides from the pitch of the previous note, in Mono and in Poly mode. 0 turns glide off.
PITCH (Pitch)	-12 to +12 semitones	0	Global transposition. The control is continuous: use whole values to stay in tune.
RATE (LFO Rate)	0.05 to 20 Hz	4 Hz	LFO speed. Not tempo-synced.
AMOUNT (LFO Amount)	0 to 1	0	LFO depth. The mod wheel adds to this value.
LFO Source (menu)	Sine, Triangle, Saw, Square, Sample&Hold	Sine	LFO shape. The LFO restarts at every new note. Sample&Hold picks a new random value once per cycle.
Destination (menu)	Pitch, Filter, Amp, Timbre	Pitch	LFO target. Pitch: up to +/-1 semitone (vibrato). Filter: up to +/-3 octaves (wobble). Amp: up to 50% level dip (tremolo). Timbre: moves all five character controls by up to +/-0.5.
Mono/Poly (menu)	Poly, Mono	Poly	Poly: up to 16 notes at once. Mono: one note at a time, last-note priority.
DISTORTION (Distortion)	0 to 1	0	Saturation on the summed output, with automatic level compensation.
CHORUS (Chorus)	0 to 1	0	Stereo chorus mix (slow, fixed rate).
DELAY (Delay)	0 to 1	0	Level of the ping-pong delay.
TIME (Delay Time)	0.05 to 1.0 s	0.35 s	Delay time in seconds. Not tempo-synced: for a quarter note, use 60 / BPM (0.5 s at 120 BPM); halve it for an eighth note.
FEEDBACK (Feedback)	0 to 0.9	0.35	Number of delay repeats (0 to 90% feedback).

Parameter	Range	Default	Function
REVERB (Reverb)	0 to 1	0.25	Reverb amount. Higher values also enlarge the room.
Pitch Bend wheel (Pitch Bend)	-1 to +1	0	On-screen pitch bend, +/-2 semitones. Adds to MIDI pitch bend.
Modulation wheel (Mod Wheel)	0 to 1	0	On-screen mod wheel. Adds up to +0.8 to the LFO AMOUNT.

Character controls by engine

Engine	TONE	BODY	BRIGHT	WIDTH	TEXTURE
Arena Sub	Pitch “knock” at the attack	Adds the octave harmonic	Attack click	No effect	Saturation
Slap Bass	Pluck hardness	String sustain	Brighter, longer highs	Low body resonance (around 95 Hz)	Slap click
Moog Bass	Sub-octave level	Output weight	Built-in low-pass opening	Detune of the second saw	Blend from saws to square
Stadium Reese	Sub-octave level	Detune amount	Built-in low-pass opening	Saturation drive	Noise
FM Growl	Modulator ratio (0.5 to 3.5)	No effect	FM depth (growl intensity)	Speed of the built-in wobble (0.5 to 12.5 Hz)	Modulator feedback (grit)
Acid Rubber	Saw to pulse blend	Length of the built-in filter sweep	Depth of the built-in filter sweep	No effect	Saturation
Stadium Horns	Swell time of the built-in filter	Output weight	How far the filter opens	Detune of the three saws	Breath noise
Arena Kick	Pitch-drop depth	Decay length	Click	No effect	Saturation

Factory presets

ARENA BASS includes 70 factory presets in 7 banks of 10. All banks except Stadium Horns load in Mono mode. In the Stadium Horns bank, only Lead Horn is in Mono mode (with a short glide).

Arena Sub: Arena 808, Stadium Rumble, Long Slide Sub, Locker Room Sub, Hard Knock Bass, Short Pump, Smooth Court, Pitch Drop Dunk, Dirty Overtime, Scoreboard Sub.

Slap & Pluck Bass: Slap Bass, Pick Bass, Finger Funk, Muted Pocket, Upright Arena, Pop Slap, Deep Pluck, Chorus Bass, Dub Pluck, Walking Court.

Moog Bass: Arena Moog, Fat Moog, Rubber Moog, Sub Moog, Slide Moog, Pump Bass, Octave Moog, Hot Seat, Bass Stab, Warm Anthem.

Reese & Growl: Stadium Reese, Dirty Reese, Wobble Arena, Industrial Reese, Sub Reese, FM Growl, Talking Bass, Robot Growl, Metal Growl, Slow Growl.

Acid & Rubber: Acid Rubber, Squelch, Rubber Band, Acid Slide, Pulse Acid, Dirty Acid, Open Acid, Low Rubber, Pump Squelch, Buzzer Beater.

Stadium Horns: Stadium Horns, Fanfare, Brass Stab, Victory Horns, Soft Flugel, Slow Swell, Hit Section, Low Horns, Lead Horn, Anthem.

Kicks & Stomps: Arena Kick, Stomp, Long Boom, Punch Kick, Sub Kick, Crowd Stomp, Dirty Kick, Tom Fill, Drop Impact, Laser Kick.

Loading a preset first resets every parameter to its default value, then applies the preset. The two wheels are not changed.

User presets. Click the disk icon to save the current sound as a `.abpreset` file. The default folder is `Documents\DJBILBOX BEATS\ARENA_BASS\Presets`. Files in this folder appear in the **User** submenu of the preset menu. Use **Open a .abpreset file...** in the same menu to load a file from another location. The preset display shows the file name.

The host also sees the 70 factory presets as a program list. Your project saves the full state of the plugin, including the preset name.

Moog is a trademark of its owner. It is used here only to describe a sound style. DJBILBOX BEATS is not affiliated with the trademark owner.

Production tips

1. **Trap and Drill 808s.** Start from Arena 808 or Long Slide Sub. Raise TONE for a harder knock on short notes. Raise TEXTURE or add a little DISTORTION so the 808 stays audible on phone and laptop speakers.
2. **808 slides.** With GLIDE above zero, every new note slides from the previous one, even if the notes do not overlap. For slides on selected notes only, keep GLIDE at 0 and automate it up just before the notes that should slide.
3. **G-Funk bass.** Use the Moog Bass bank (Slide Moog, Fat Moog). Set GLIDE around 0.1 to 0.2 and play legato lines. Raise ENV and shorten the filter D slider for a rounder “pluck” at the start of each note.
4. **Afrotrap and Afro bass.** The Slap & Pluck bank (Muted Pocket, Finger Funk, Pick Bass) gives bouncy, percussive lines. These presets are quieter by nature, so raise VOLUME. Use VELOCITY around 0.6 to 0.8 so accents in your Piano roll come through.
5. **Deep House and acid.** Load Arena Moog or a preset from the Acid & Rubber bank. Automate FILTER over 8 or 16 bars. For movement, set Destination to Filter with a Square or Sample&Hold LFO, as in Pump Squelch.
6. **Reese and wobble.** On the Stadium Reese engine, BODY sets the detune and WIDTH drives the saturation. Set Destination to Filter, LFO Source to Sine and RATE between 1 and 4 Hz for a wobble (see Wobble Arena).
7. **Horn hooks and anthems.** The Stadium Horns bank plays chords in Poly mode. Raise ATTACK for swells (Slow Swell) or shorten DECAY and SUSTAIN for stabs (Hit Section). Add REVERB and CHORUS for a stadium-size sound.
8. **Kicks and stomps.** Load the Kicks & Stomps presets in a second ARENA BASS instance, so the kick and the 808 keep separate envelopes. Play kicks around MIDI notes 28 to 40 (E2 to E3 in FL Studio). TONE sets the pitch drop, BODY the length and BRIGHT the click. Tom Fill is transposed one octave up for fills.

MIDI, automation and performance

Notes and channels. ARENA BASS responds to all 128 MIDI notes on any MIDI channel. Velocity controls the level according to the VELOCITY slider.

Polyphony. Up to 16 voices in Poly mode. When you play a 17th note, a voice is taken over and cut immediately. In Mono mode, each new note stops the previous one (last-note priority). Releasing the newest note does not bring back an earlier note that you still hold.

Pitch bend. MIDI pitch bend covers +/-2 semitones. The on-screen Pitch Bend wheel adds another +/-2 semitones.

Mod wheel (CC1). CC1 raises the LFO depth, like the on-screen Modulation wheel. When both are used, the higher value wins. CC1 acts on the notes that are sounding when the message arrives, so move the wheel while you play. For repeatable results in a song, automate the on-screen **Mod Wheel** parameter instead.

Other MIDI. The sustain pedal (CC64) is supported. All Notes Off and All Sound Off messages stop the sound. Aftertouch is ignored.

Automation in FL Studio. All 35 parameters can be automated. Move a control in the plugin, then use **Tools > Last tweaked > Create automation clip**. Use **Tools > Last tweaked > Link to controller** to assign a hardware knob. You can also pick parameters from the plugin wrapper menu (**Browse parameters**). Level, pitch, bend, filter, distortion and delay changes are smoothed to avoid clicks.

Latency and tail. The plugin adds no latency (0 samples), so no delay compensation is needed. It reports a 12-second tail to the host so reverb and delay trails are not cut when rendering.

CPU. ARENA BASS is lightweight. Effects set to zero are bypassed and cost no CPU. Mono mode and short release times keep the voice count low. The plugin works at 44.1, 48, 88.2 and 96 kHz.

FAQ

ARENA BASS does not appear in FL Studio. Open **Options > Manage plugins**, check that `C:\Program Files\Common Files\VST3` is in the search paths, then click **Find installed plugins**. The plugin is listed as **ARENA_BASS** under **DJBILBOX BEATS**. It is an instrument: load it in the Channel rack, not in a Mixer insert slot.

I hear nothing, or almost nothing, when I click the on-screen keyboard. The on-screen keyboard covers the lowest MIDI notes (0 to 31), and most of them are below what speakers can reproduce. Play from a MIDI keyboard or the Piano roll around C2 to C5 (FL Studio naming). Also check VOLUME, and check that FILTER is not closed with Filter Type set to Low Pass.

My 808 is not perfectly centered. Each note gets a slight random stereo offset. For a strictly centered sub, reduce the stereo separation of the mixer track in FL Studio, or insert a mono utility after ARENA BASS. If the bass is also weak on small speakers, add harmonics with TEXTURE, BODY or DISTORTION.

Every note slides into the next one. GLIDE is above zero. Glide applies to every new note. Set GLIDE to 0, or automate it only where you want slides.

My chord only plays one note. The Mono/Poly menu is set to Mono, which is the default for bass presets. Switch it to Poly.